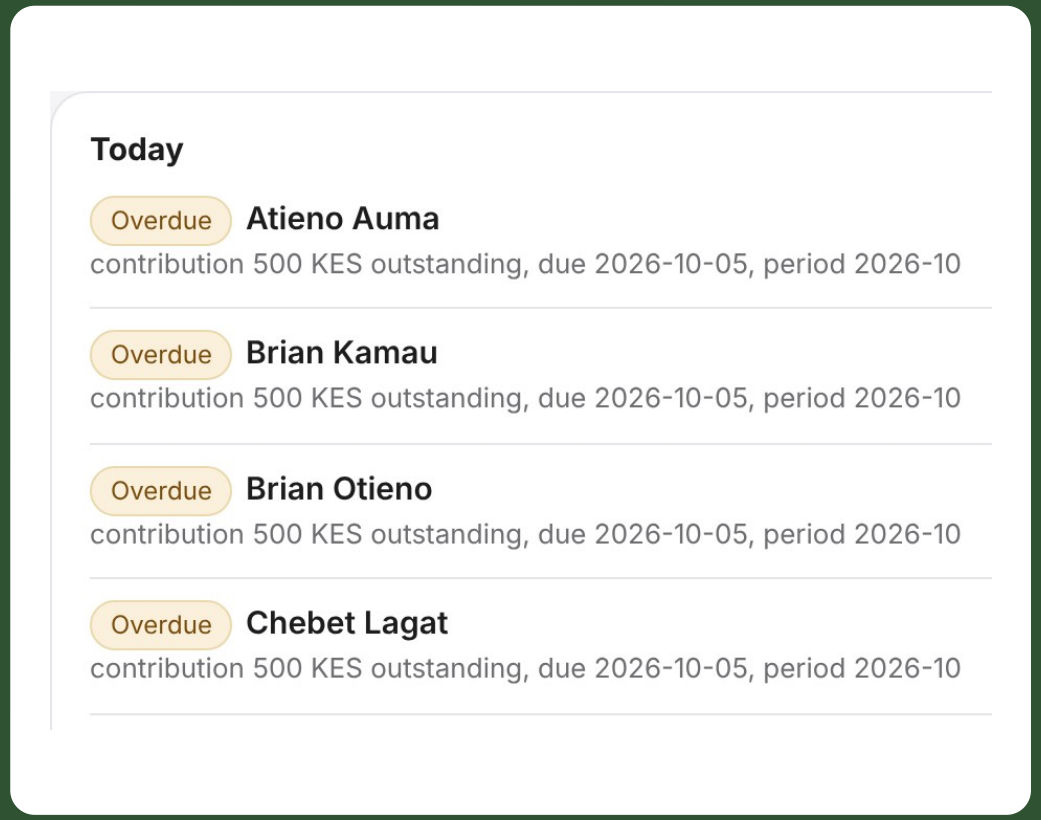
Umwayi-RM

The secretary that never decides

An open-source assistant for savings groups. A belief, a test, and an honest result.

Indie Developer track, Build for Your World
Solo entry by Miguel Shinyenyi, Nairobi



The real console, synthetic group

Records live in notebooks and chats

1

Names collide

Two members share a first name. Which one paid?

2

Months go missing

A payment is in a voice note, a chat message, or nowhere.

3

Totals disagree

The notebook says one number and the group chat says another.

I have not interviewed treasurers yet.

The problem is a hypothesis. Everything you see is a synthetic group, built to show how the tool behaves.

Scale, as reported: news coverage of a Ministry of Co-operatives statement says chamas manage over Sh300 billion. That is a reported figure, not one I measured.

I believed rules would make an AI careful

I wanted an assistant that asks when it is unsure, not one that guesses.

The belief

Short rules, written from past mistakes, make an agent ask instead of guess.

The rule I would not bend

The model proposes. Code owns the ledger.

So I measured it

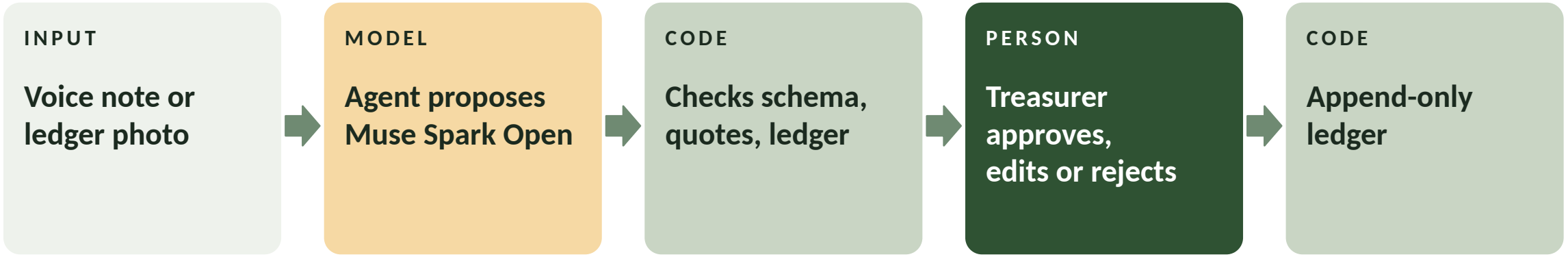
4 prompts, same model

3 random seeds

120 frozen test notes per prompt

Each seed: 16 ambiguous notes and 24 clear ones.

The model proposes, the treasurer decides



The agent never writes the ledger

It writes proposals. Only approval changes state.

Every proposal quotes its words

A check rejects a proposal whose quote is not in the note.

Nothing is sent, nothing moves

No money, no messages, no scores for members.

Meta models: Muse Spark Open on Baseten runs the agent loop, tools and reading. Muse Voice Transcribe handles voice. The Lab trace shows the model id.

A voice note becomes quoted proposals

THE TREASURER SPEAKS

“Atieno paid 500 for October. Chebet sent 500 as well.”

Example note, synthetic



Propose: Atieno Auma, contribution, 500 KES, 2026-10

Evidence: “Atieno paid 500 for October”

Propose: Chebet Lagat, contribution, 500 KES, 2026-10

Evidence: “Chebet sent 500 as well”

Proposals wait in an inbox. Nothing changes until the treasurer approves.

Illustration of the flow. The live demo shows the real run, with the model id in the trace.

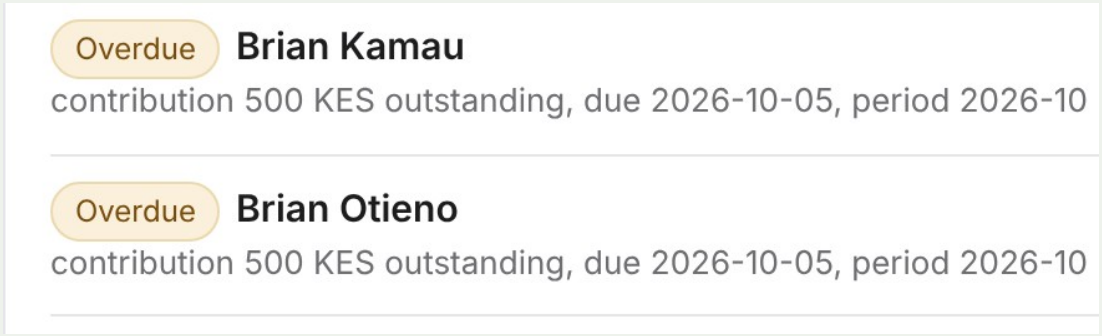
Two Brians: the agent asks

“Brian paid 500 for October.”

AGENT ASKS

Which Brian: Brian Kamau or Brian Otieno?

The treasurer answers and the run continues. On 48 ambiguous test notes the curated prompt never guessed. Neither did the generic one. The bare prompt guessed 7 times.



Real console. The synthetic group has two members named Brian, and both are overdue.

A first name is not an identity. When the agent cannot tell, it asks.

A paper page becomes questions

ON THE PAPER PAGE

```
Zawadi Muthoni  500
Njeri Wambui  500
```

Example rows, synthetic

IN THE STORED LEDGER

```
Njeri Wambui  300
```

Code compares both lists.

FINDINGS, AS QUESTIONS

Zawadi is on paper but not in the ledger. Add it?

Njeri: paper says 500, ledger says 300. Which is right?

The agent reads the page. Code does the comparing. Differences are questions, not faults.

Illustration with example rows. The live demo uses a photographed page.

Approve twice, one entry. Model off, it works

1

Approve twice, one entry

Approving the same proposal again changes nothing. A test covers it.

2

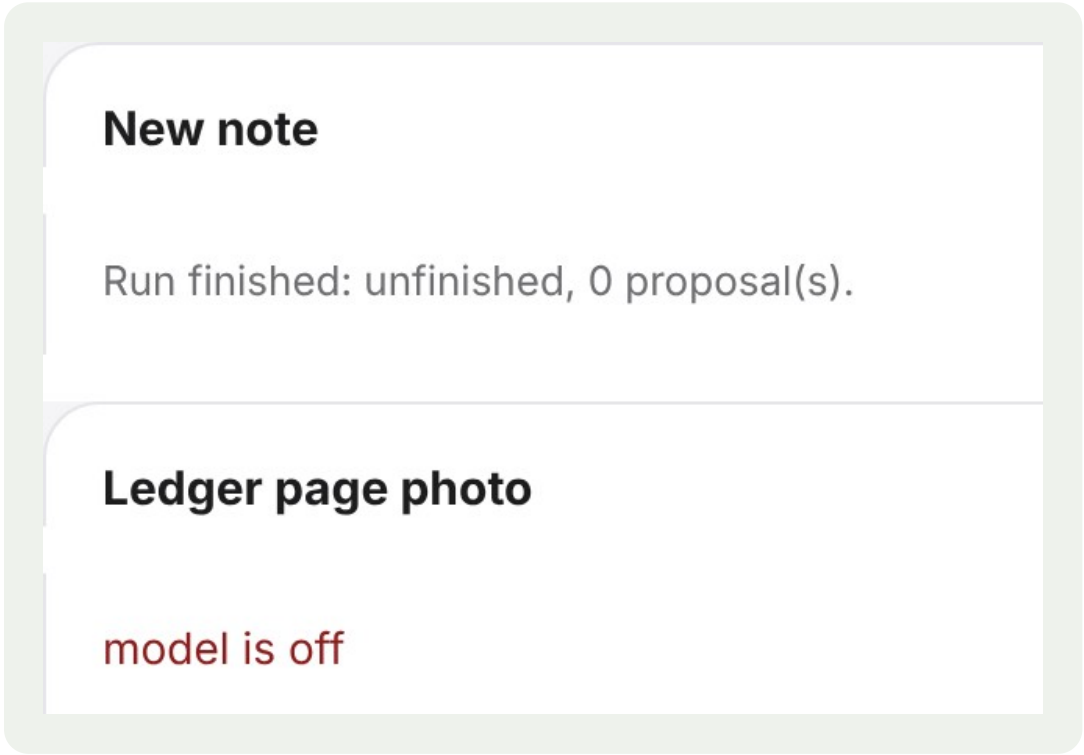
State changes only on approval

Reject or ignore a proposal and the ledger stays the same.

3

Model off, the list still works

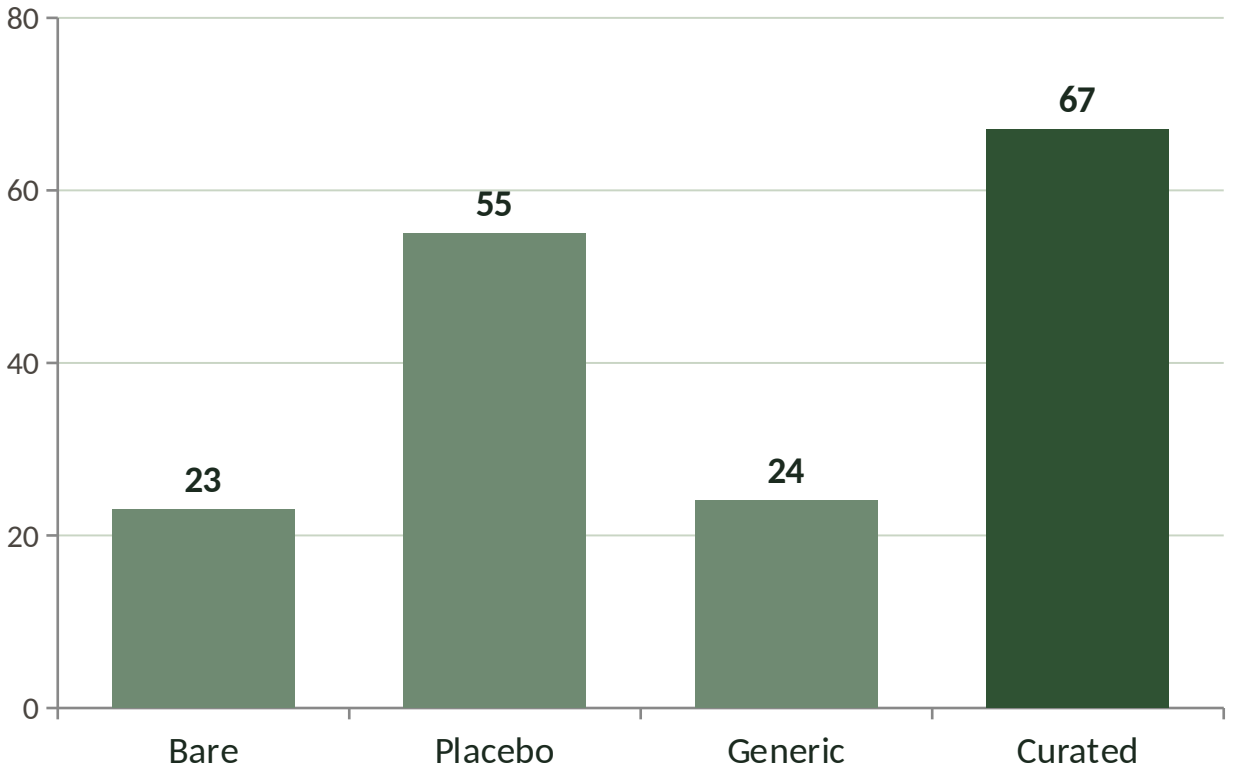
No keys: Today and manual entry run. Voice and photo answer “model is off”.



Real console with no keys set.

Generic rules over-asked. Curated rules did not

Clear notes handled correctly, out of 72



7 of 48 ambiguous notes where the bare prompt guessed

0 of 48 for the placebo, generic and curated prompts

67 vs 24 clear notes handled, curated vs generic, of 72

Same model, frozen test split, 3 seeds, synthetic data. Source: docs/evals.

What held and what did not

Held

- Curated rules kept clear notes moving: 67 of 72 handled, against 24 of 72 for a generic “ask when unsure” prompt.
- Any added prompt cut guessing: 7 of 48 for the bare prompt, 0 of 48 for the rest.
- Code-owned ledger, idempotent approval and the model-off path pass their tests.

Did not hold

- Restraint claim: curated 0 of 48 against generic 0 of 48. A floor effect, so the two cannot be told apart.
- A placebo prompt reached 55 of 72. Most of the gain may come from prompt length and form, not from the rules.
- Archive claim (one seed): core plus archive 19 of 20, plain retrieval 20 of 20, truncation 13 of 20. Not better than retrieval.

What is not proven, and what I need

Not proven

- That treasurers prefer it to a notebook or to Chamasoft
- That it reduces errors in real groups
- Security and Data Protection Act compliance
- That the rules help beyond this synthetic set and model

What I need

One pilot group for a month, and feedback from treasurers.

Open source, MIT licence.

github.com/Miguel-Shinyenyi/umwayi-rm

Miguel Shinyenyi, Nairobi